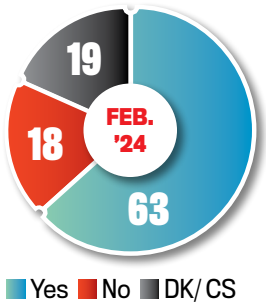
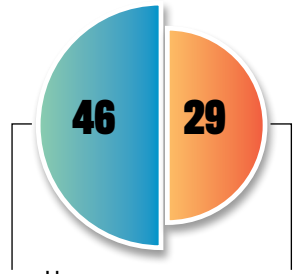
Q. Will you boycott a trip to the Maldives given India's recent tensions with that country?



The Maldivian ministers' comments have prompted a majority to support a hard stand

Q. Do you see Israel's counter-strike in Gaza as genocide or legitimate retaliation to terrorism?



Israel has done no wrong considering the barbaric act committed by Hamas

Israel is committing genocide in the name of self-defence

(Rest, DK/ CS)

Q. How do you view India's response to Canada alleging that it was involved in Hardeep Singh Nijjar's killing?



India's strong denial of the charges and the swift diplomatic action won approval

All figures in % and rounded off

(more than any other country), it was a significant blow. Similar sentiments were echoed by over 63 per cent of the MOTN respondents, who supported a boycott of the Maldives; only 18 per cent opposed the move.

India's Neighbourhood First Policy focuses on peaceful ties and collaborative development with its South Asian neighbours. However, Chinese interference and influence has been growing in the Maldives, Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Nepal, leading to a cooling of ties with India. On how they rate India's ties with neighbours, over 30 per cent of the respondents felt they have deteriorated, but that it doesn't matter. Nearly 26 per cent see an improvement, while 26 per cent also acknowledge that ties have deteriorated and that it is worrying.

On Israel's invasion of Gaza—sparked by Hamas's October 7 attack that left 1,139 Israelis dead—New Delhi, with its policy of zero tolerance to terrorism, has condemned the Hamas attack as an instance of it, but not banned the terror group, maintaining a tightrope walk. Israel's counter-strike has left 26,500 Palestinians dead and 65,000 injured or missing. When asked if they see this as genocide or legitimate retaliation against terrorism, almost 29 per cent of the MOTN respondents say that Israel is committing a crime in the name of self-defence. More than 45 per cent of the respondents say Israel has done 'no wrong'.

With terrorists trained in Pakistan launching attacks on the army in recent months, a majority of the respondents have said 'no' to talks with Islamabad

What about the country many Indians love to hate the most? Last year, when former Pakistan PM Shehbaz Sharif asked New Delhi to address issues through "peaceful and meaningful discussions", India was prompt to respond by reiterating its principled stand—that "an environment free of terror and hostility is imperative" for that. Six months later, as Pakistan-backed terror groups have launched repeated attacks on the Indian army, especially in Jammu, over 55 per cent of the MOTN respondents reject the idea of talks with Pakistan. Only 26 per cent support talks. ■